

IN the vast hall of the Commonwealth Sport General Assembly in Glasgow in late November, beats of the dhol suddenly filled the air and garba dancers swept across the floor—an exuberant flourish after Ahmedabad was officially declared host of the 2030 Commonwealth Games. For Gujarat's deputy chief minister Harsh Sanghavi, Indian Olympic Association (IOA) chief P.T. Usha and other officials present, the moment carried little surprise. What it sharpened instead was the sheer scale of the task ahead.

That sense had been building for weeks. Once the Executive Board of Commonwealth Sport recommended Ahmedabad in mid-October, the Glasgow ratification was a formality. Yet 15 years after India's bruising experience hosting the 2010 Commonwealth Games in Delhi—an edition marred by cost overruns, collapsing infrastructure and political scandal—the country is effectively being handed a second chance. And this time, officials insist, the stakes extend far beyond an 11-day sporting spectacle.

Branded as Amdavad 2030, the centenary edition of the international multi-sport event has placed a non-metro city at the forefront of India's global sporting ambitions and will serve as a crucial rehearsal for its ambitious bid to host the 2036 Summer Olympics. "The [Commonwealth] Games will accelerate Amdavad's emergence as India's premier sports hub," the Gujarat government had said in its proposal. Prime Minister Narendra Modi underscored the national aspiration, posting on X that India was now "firmly on the global sporting map". Yet Amdavad 2030 will be judged not just by spectacle, but by governance, finance, sporting depth and execution. For India and Ahmedabad's Olympic dream, it is both proving ground and pressure point.

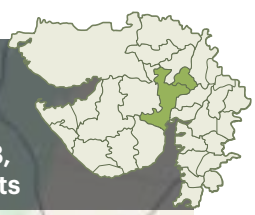
HOW AHMEDABAD WON

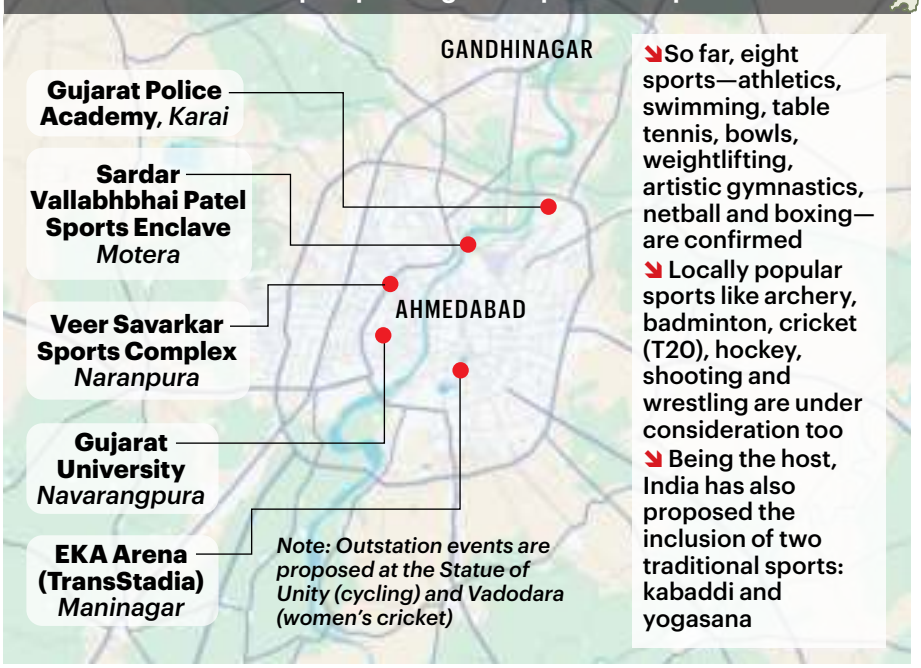
Gujarat's campaign began in January 2025 after senior policymakers concluded that hosting more global sporting events would strengthen India's Olympic claim. The first hurdle was domestic politics. In a coalition government, consensus had to be built around Ahmedabad as host, with Bhubaneswar, Hyderabad and New Delhi also in the running.

Ahmedabad's eventual selection raised

AMDAVAD 2030 GAME PLAN

Focused on the Ahmedabad–Gandhinagar cluster, the masterplan targets full infrastructure completion by 2028, with Commonwealth Sport pitching a lineup of 15–17 sports





- So far, eight sports—athletics, swimming, table tennis, bowls, weightlifting, artistic gymnastics, netball and boxing—are confirmed
- Locally popular sports like archery, badminton, cricket (T20), hockey, shooting and wrestling are under consideration too
- Being the host, India has also proposed the inclusion of two traditional sports: kabaddi and yogasana